



INITIATE**SOLAR**

**"Harnessing natural energy
for a better tomorrow."**

Solar Consultant's Handbook



www.Initiate.solar

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Welcome to



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EZ Solar

- + \$0 Down. Zero out of Pocket Cost.
- + Escape Increasing Energy Bills
- + Fix Electrical cost for 25 years
- + Increase Property Value
- + Solar Federal/State Tax Incentives
- + Cleaner Renewable Energy
- + Keep our Air and Water Clean



Initiate Solar Partners

We educate, empower and Initiate the change for a better tomorrow.

Today Solar Energy is more affordable than ever, with Federal and State Incentives making it all possible for homeowners to start producing cleaner power. We've been in the industry for 7 Years and over the years we've developed two missions for Initiate Solar.

Mission #1: Our mission is to help residential homeowners understand their choices when it comes to switching over to solar. We work with local installers to provide the best experience possible. All of our partners are vetted and certified professionals to get the job done.

Mission #2: We consult independent solar contractors to improve sales, training, and marketing techniques to scale their business.

Our reliable build partners handle the fulfillment of installing our customers with Tier 1 equipment available in the market, having multiple build partners allow us to extend our network and simultaneously giving our customers more options.

Whom do we work with?

- **Titan Solar Power**
- **Brilliant Solar**
- **Palmetto Solar**
- **Summit Energy**
- **White Lable Solar**
- **Bright Planet Solar**



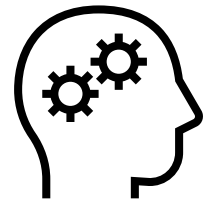
What to Expect

"Harnessing natural energy for a better tomorrow."

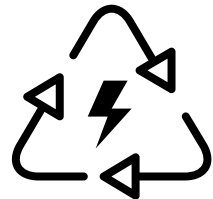
Learn how to can start a career in the Solar Industry, by becoming a professional solar consultant. Become a profitable entrepreneur, working along side other liked minded individuals committed to always improving and crushing their goals.



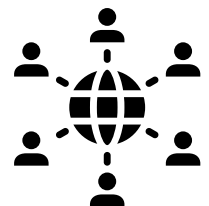
Learn the trade from other solar sales professionals that have put in the time and work to make this transition easier for you. Initiate Solar has many partners that have had, and continue to have success in the solar industry. Learn selling techniques, engage in one-to-one training by our executive partners, and develop your personal skills and attributes that contribute to your all-around success as a solar entrepreneur.



Make an impact in the world today. Every day our Earth is being polluted by our own Utility Companies. Help conserve our lakes, rivers, oceans, national parks, air quality, and the overall health of our Ecosystem. Every home that we help go solar, we help reduce that daily pollution.



Use your Network to build your business. Our direct partnership and tailored marketing strategies are put in place to ensure that you're in the right vehicle when it comes to the road to success. Welcome to Initiate Solar!



Our Mission is to help homeowners make the switch to solar as seamless as possible. We hold the utmost highest standards when it comes to ethical and moral sales practices, Here at Initiate Solar, we are committed to maximizing homeowners' benefits and ensuring a smooth transition for homeowners to make that transition to solar energy. We focus on maintaining a professional relationship with our clients and being present throughout the entire sales process. Thats Initiate Solars commitment.

"Harnessing the natural energy for a better tomorrow"



Support Team

Our in-house team is there to assist you for all your projects.



Solar Options

Offer your clients competitive finance, and PPA options.



Price Match Guarantee

Offer your clients competitive finance, and PPA options.



No Extra Costs

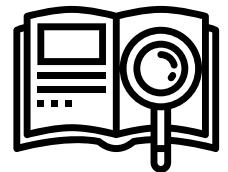
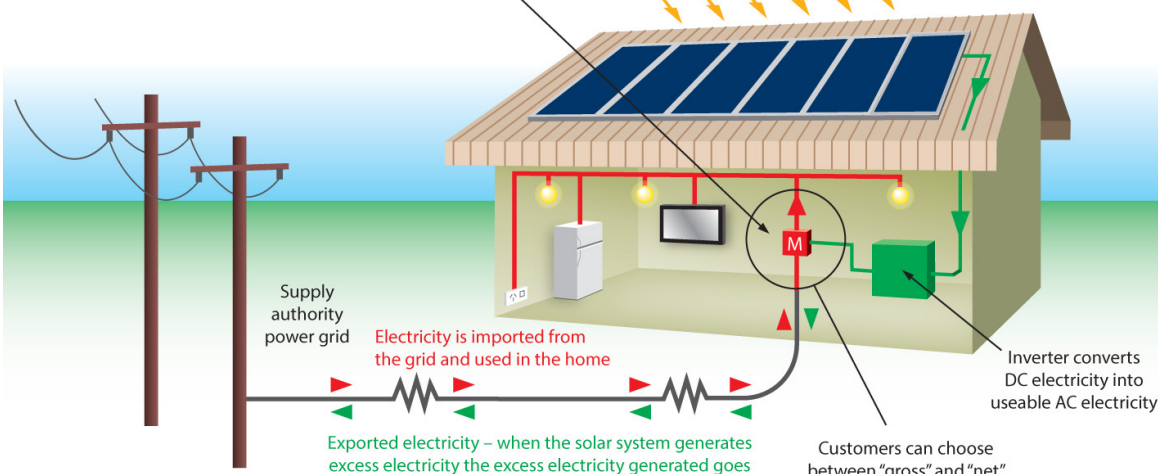
We guarantee zero out-of-pocket expense when you go solar with Initiate Solar

Electricity is imported from the grid and is metered by a new Digital 'Time of use Meter' known as the Consumption Meter.

New Digital Time of Use Consumption Meter that measures how much power your home uses and any excess power your solar power system feeds back to the grid.

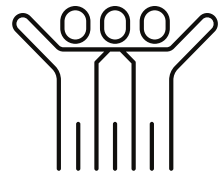


Solar panels convert sunlight into clean green DC electricity



Research

Well educated buyer is a happy buyer



You're not alone

Join the millions of homeowners to take ownership of their electricity.

1

Breakdown

Explain to the homeowner how their Utility rates work & Explain Solar benefits.

2

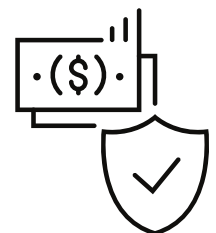
Customized Design

Review how much electrical production you need, show you your customized solar designed.

3

Qualify

Soft Credit Check & Review Tax Deductible Eligibility



Financial Security

Lock in your electricity cost for the next 25 years. Fixed Energy Cost.

The Process

"Initiate, educate and empower yourself
and your customers."

Lead Generation / Prospecting

Canvassing (Door knocking)
Warm Markets
Social Media
Referrals
Partnerships
Friends & Family
Advertisements

Sales/ Consulting

Follow ups
Customer/ Client Relations
Preparations
Product Knowledge
Industry Knowledge
Build Communication skills
Sales Techniques
Mind Frame Management
In-home Consulting
Virtual Consulting
Contract Management
Project Management

Customer Management / Closing

Customer / Client Relations
Contract Management
Project Management
Personal Organization
Professional Oversight
Following up
Commitment Fullfilment

Federal Investment Tax Credit

"What is a tax credit?"

A tax credit is a dollar-for-dollar reduction in the amount of income tax you would otherwise owe. For example, claiming a \$1,000 federal tax credit reduces your federal income taxes due by \$1,000. The federal tax credit is sometimes referred to as an Investment Tax Credit, or ITC, though is different from the ITC offered to businesses that own solar systems.

What is the federal solar tax credit?

The federal residential solar energy credit is a tax credit that can be claimed on federal income taxes for a percentage of the cost of a solar photovoltaic (PV) system. (Other types of renewable energy are also eligible for similar credits but are beyond the scope of this guidance.)

The system must be placed in service during the tax year and generate electricity for a home located in the United States. There is no bright-line test from the IRS on what constitutes "placed in service," but the IRS has equated it with the completed installation. In December 2020, Congress passed an extension of the ITC, which provides a 26% tax credit for systems installed in 2020-2022, and 22% for systems installed in 2023. (Systems installed before December 31, 2019, were eligible for a 30% tax credit.) The tax credit expires starting in 2024 unless Congress renews it."

<https://www.energy.gov/eere/solar/homeowners-guide-federal-tax-credit-solar-photovoltaics>

The ITC Credits were extended for 26% return until the year 2022, Starting in 2023 the ITC Credit will be reduced to 22%. (Extension was part of the Covid-19 Relief Bill)

There is no maximum amount that can be claimed.

How Does Solar Work?

How do Solar panels work / Net Metering?

- We put photovoltaic or (PV) panels on your roof, capturing natural sunlight and converting that into electricity.
- Each solar panel has a micro-inverter on the back of each panel that converts electricity from DC (Direct Current) to AC (Alternate Current). (We use AC electrical currents in our homes).
- The AC electricity goes down to your electrical panel via a neatly laid down conduit; which will be on the meter side of your home.
- Currently, your Electrical meter is constantly spinning forward counting kilowatt-hours, charging you money as you use more and more electricity.
- We will be working with your local utility company to make sure your standard meter is upgraded to a Net Meter or Smart Meter, which will allow your meter to spin forward or backward.
- During the daytime, your solar system will create more electricity than the house will consume. Making your home an electrical producer for the local utility instead of consuming electricity from the local utility.
- In the Daytime, excess electricity will be monitored and stored by your upgraded NET Meter.
- At Nighttime your solar system won't be able to produce electricity BUT instead of consuming Kwh (unit of measurement for electricity) from the local utility company, your NET meter will feed your home the electricity that your home produced in excess to your home without consuming electricity from your electric provider.
- Like rollover minutes, you will never lose access to the electricity your solar system overproduced. This is called NET Metering.
- We get this done for you with the Inter-connection Form, which lets the local utility know that you're looking to go solar.
- If you use all of your banked Kwh from your Net Meter you will be supplemented by your electric provider, so you will always have lights in your home.
- Included with our solar system we are going to provide you at no extra cost the ability to monitor exactly how much your solar system is producing per panel, every day.



Why do people choose to go solar?

- 4.1% Equity Increase
- Sold 17%-20% Faster
- Lower Cost of Living
- Lower Monthly
- Reduce or Eliminate Bill



Utility Rate Increases

Residential electricity price growth in the U.S. 2000-2022

Published by

Bruna Alves

, Jul 6, 2021

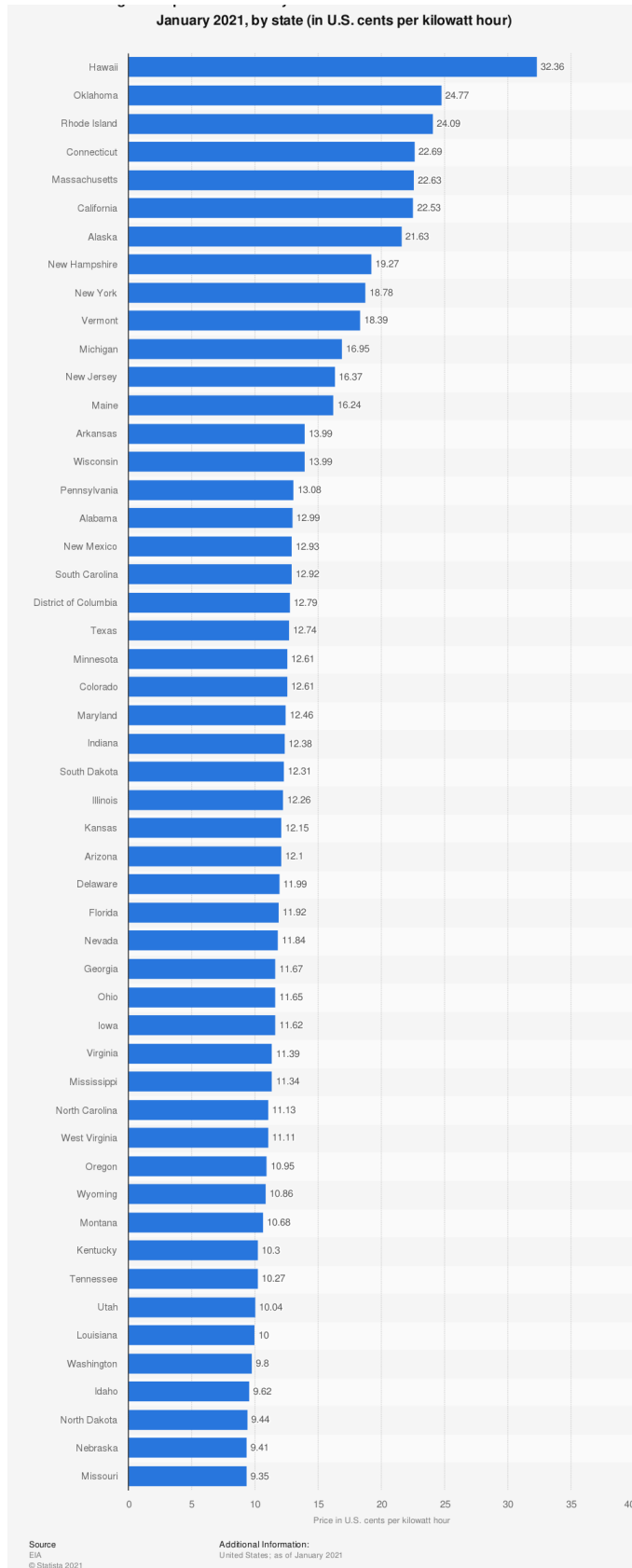
It is projected that the residential electricity price in the United States will increase by 1.3 percent between 2021 and 2022. Generally, retail electricity prices in the country have risen over the last decade. This trend is likely to continue as natural gas prices will likely also increase, raising electricity rates. As the natural gas supply is exposed to international markets that pay a higher rate, U.S. prices are also expected to rise despite a decrease in recent years that came as a result of the hydraulic fracturing boom.

States with the highest and lowest electricity prices

The price of electricity is partially dependent on the various energy sources, such as coal, gas, oil, as well as renewable or nuclear sources, used to generate power. Hawaii has one of the highest electricity prices at 32.36 U.S. cents per kilowatt-hour due to the high costs of crude oil used to fuel the state's electricity. In comparison, Idaho has one of the lowest retail rates, as much of the state's energy is generated from hydroelectricity which requires virtually no fuel, and construction costs can be spread out over decades. Bills can vary greatly depending on both state and region. Demand for electricity is also expected to increase, especially in regions that will likely require more heating and cooling as climate change impacts progress, driving up electricity prices.



Average Price Per kWh



Reasons for increases in electricity prices

The rising prices are justified by the costs of power production and power grid maintenance. Although the production cost of electricity generated from coal, natural gas and nuclear sources remained relatively flat, the integration of renewable energy sources, investments in smart grid technologies, growing peak demand and power blackouts caused by the vicissitudes of nature continued to trouble the electric utility industry in the recent past. The average U.S. electricity prices per state can also vary widely, with Hawaii residents experiencing some of the highest rates in the country.

<https://www.statista.com/statistics/201714/growth-in-us-residential-electricity-prices-since-2000/>



Help Spread the Word

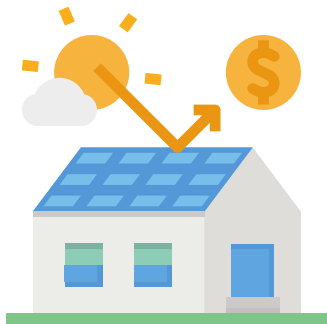
The Problem:



Utility rates continue to rise, studies have shown that this trend will continue to increase. The way our current utility companies are producing energy is harming our environment. The cost to maintain and repair the electrical infrastructure becomes more and more expensive as demand continues to increase. By 2024, only 2.5 percent of all U.S. homes will have solar installations. Very few homeowners are knowledgeable about the benefits of transitioning to renewable energy. Solar Energy is more affordable and always a better alternative for our environment and our future generations.



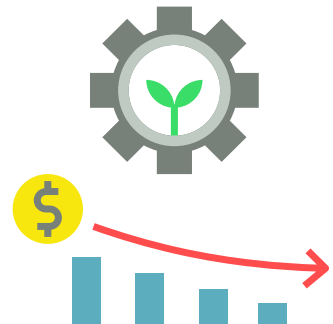
The Solution:



Predictability: Fixed monthly payments
(No Hidden Cost)

Control: Own your power instead of
consuming from Utilities

Protection: Against raising utility rates
and services charges.



Panels get installed

Bills go down
Savings over time

The Opportunity:



Learn how to educate homeowners about the different solar incentives provided for choosing to generate their own power through solar energy. Explain Federal and State tax incentives

Earn money
by helping
others save
money.

Solarpreneur Vs Employment

Entrepreneurship in the solar industry is a **LIFESTYLE**

What is Entrepreneurship?

Sacrifice:

- What are you willing to give up that doesn't truly serve your purpose?
- Time-consuming activities, relationships, bad habits

Extra level of Commitment:

- What got you here, will not get you where you want to go
- Changes are going to be made to become a new person to get different results

State Of Discomfort:

- Comfort is the enemy of greatness
- We grow from discomfort

Daily Challenge:

- Do the work you run from the most

Continues growth and development:

- A new life comes from a new you.
- Constant self-evaluation, self-development, and investing in oneself are key .

Employee Vs Self-Employed

What happens when you chose to Employ yourself?

- Make your own hours
- Your efforts will determine your rewards
- You can achieve financial freedom and eventually financial independence
- Be your own boss





Developing a Winning Mindset

keys to Winning in Solar

What is your level of commitment to your vision and purpose?

What are three things you can sacrifice that will help you accomplish your goals?

Prospecting out on the field

Objective: Look for qualified interested buyers, gather information for proposal and set a time and date for a set consultation

What are the key factors to accomplishing the objective?

- Transfer of Enthusiasm and Energy
- Build trust and respect from the customer to you and vice versa
- Educate and cover all bases with your customer
- Empower the customers' ability to make decision
- Follow a proven system to the best of your ability, and do not skip any steps

Lead Generating

Objective: Understand and master all aspects of lead-generation

- Canvassing
- Warm-Market
- Cold Calling
- Social Media
- Aligned partnerships

Canvassing (Door to Door) Approach

On the field Check List

- Properly dressed for the weather
- ID badge
- Charged Tablet/Phone
- Backup battery charger
- Comfortable shoes
- Gameplan

6 Keys to Prospecting Effectively

- Positive Attitude (Mental Toughness)
- Goals (Eye on the prize)
- Planning (From the night before)
- Execution (Integrity)
- Understand NO
- Law of averages

Positive Attitude: "You Attract, what you focus on."

The first concept is one of the toughest concepts for most humans to grasp. Individuals that display a negative mindset will also display a victim mentality. Life is hard, some of us have lived tougher life than others, some of us have had a more privileged life than others. But when it comes to sales, we are all on the same leveled playing field. Just like sports, sales is all based on performance on the field. The better your performance, the greater chance you have at accomplishing your goal.

Being positive is easy. Staying positive is probably one of the hardest things to do. So how can we make sure that, 1. We're positive and 2. How do we keep that positive mindset? Any change that we want from ourselves starts internally. That internal change is expressing itself externally and will start affecting your environment accordingly. Making internal changes for oneself means, disrupting limiting beliefs, disrupting negative habits and ultimately changing the way your mind processes all the information that's being absorbed on a daily basis.

Self Reflect if you have any bad habits that are preventing you from leveling up. Bad Habits are poisonous to your future, and if unchecked can kill any dream you may have.

2. **Goals**

Goals are meant to keep us focused. Goals keep us aligned with the outcome that we truly want for ourselves. Make sure that your goals are big enough to inspire you but not scare you. What happens a lot is that most people set their goals too high and their aspirations are so big that they cold feet. So make sure you set realistic goals for yourself based not on what you believe you can accomplish but based on what you would work extremely hard to accomplish. Set your goals and your mind will seek ways to accomplish them. Your mind is a supercomputer, treat it as such by providing it with the proper software, and your mind will begin working accordingly to the results that you want. This is impossible if you are still unclear about your vision and you're why. If you don't have clearly defined goals, you will end up miserable, depressed, and a sense of unfulfillment. The way to combat this is through our enthusiasm, enthusiasm is generated by our goals.

Take the time out to think about what you want to accomplish in the next 30, 60 and 90 days. Make professional and personal goals.

3. Planning

Ok, so you've worked on your attitude and mindset. You've taken the time out to create the ideal vision and have clearly written down your goals. We've figured out the desired outcome now we need to plan out and strategies on how we're going to get to the endpoint, which will be your goals. With your clarified goals you will be able to reverse engineer the exact steps you need to take to get there. A goal without a plan is just a dream. The night before you go out to the field, write down the top 6 things that you need to do to get you closer to your goal. Plan out your day, how long you will work on follow-ups, at what time you're going to start knocking on doors if you have appointments if you have to go to a homeowner to get docs signed.

Tip: If you plan on knocking all day, split your days up into 3-hour intervals so you don't burn yourself out.

Example: It's best to if yourself some short-term goals and challenge yourself to produce results with every 3-hour interval, whether it's generating a lead, going back for a follow-up, or closing a deal. The more conversations you have throughout the day the closer you will get to producing the results that you are looking to acquire.

1st day 10:00 am- 1:00 pm

2nd day 1:30pm- 3:30pm

30 min Break

3rd day 4:00 pm -7:00 pm

Final Hours 7:00 pm + Appointments

Final Results: 3 Leads & 1 Close

A second part of planning your day out is making sure that you are ready to tackle anything the day throws at you. So plan for the weather, if it's raining bring an umbrella and if it's cold make sure you bundle up and are as warm and comfortable as possible. Don't make excuses if your desire is high enough you will accomplish your goals. The Elements will test you and test how strong your WHY is.

4. Execution:

Stick to the game plan. Stay true to yourself, and finish what you started. Some days are going to be easier than others, but with the right attitude, preparation, and planning you will get the results you need. A rule you should keep in mind is the Law of Averages. For every 4 qualified leads on average, you'll have 1 qualified lead that has the greatest odds of closing. Not every lead you generate will close but you should treat each and every one as if they will transition into a qualified closed account.

Be confident on the doors, PRACTICE, DRILL, RESHERSE. Have your presentation memorized, know your most common objections about your service.

Keep your presentation Short and Simple.

Become a master of listening.

Practice SPR Stimulus, Pause, Respond

Keep a high level of enthusiasm.

Stimulus: A comment, Statement, area of concern, or answer to your question that your prospect might give you.

Pause: Listen intently, do not interrupt, smile to lower defense, nod your head to physically acknowledge what you are listening to what they are saying as they speak. Create some eye contact to build trust.

Response: Acknowledge their comment or statement and respond accordingly.

Practice different sales scenarios

Drill your proper response to your common objections

Rehearse these sales scenarios until you can respond by reflex

Example of Pitch #1: Feel free to use this pitch, or modify it to your liking.

Hey how is it going my name is _____. I've been working in the neighborhood for the last couple of weeks, working with a bunch of (Utility Company) customers.

(Q) You get your electricity from (Utility Company) right?

(A) yes

(Q) Are you the homeowner here?

(A) Yes, I am

(B) No, I am not. (R) That's ok, what's the best time I could possibly catch him if I pop by sometime?

We are out here working with them in regards to the federal incentives for homeowners that produce their own energy.

(Q) You've heard about the different programs available to you correct?

(A) yes/no

Well, I don't know if you heard what is going on with all the utility companies in (State). It's actually been on the cover of (Newspaper) And on the (Local News TV).

(add your own twist next) "In a Nutshell/ I'll keep it short / Real quick"

The power company has been increasing the price of our electricity due to inflation and the cost to produce and transport power to your home.

For the last couple of years, homeowners have been choosing to produce their own power as opposed to consuming electricity from the grid.

To protect themselves from additional Rate hikes, service fees, renewable energy programs, and taxes.

If you have the most recent electric bill I can show you which charges would be reduced and in some cases eliminated.

Roughly, how much do you pay every month to your utility company?

Do you have a copy of it inside?

And how long have you had your utility company service you?

Create your own series of questions with your goal, is getting a clear picture of the electric bill so you can get a solar design for the house, and generate a proposal for your prospect.

5. Understanding the word NO

Learning to accept **NO** is going to build your tolerance to rejection. It's human nature to dislike rejection because it creates discomfort for us in many ways.

Reasons why people say no:

- Confused about what you're doing
- Doesn't truly understand how it works
- Unanswered questions
- Needs more clarification
- Bad Timing

When on the doors you will hear more NO's than Yes's. There's a formula to use as prospecting. Put a monetary value on each NO you Receive and pretend that every time you get a "NOT INTERESTED, NO, SOLAR IS NOT FOR ME" you earn \$100 for example. Now psychologically you won't receive that rejection as hard because it's a win-win situation for you.

Turn every interaction into a win-win situation for you.

You do this by understanding the different prospects you might encounter out on the field.

There is 4 different type of buyers:

- Interested
- Qualified and shopping
- Not qualified but interested
- Not interested



Interested Buyers: The INTERESTED are your ideal customers, this is the person that knows about your product or service and has been waiting for someone to present it to them. They're usually ready to take immediate action, they know they qualify, they know the benefits, value, and wants the service as fast as possible. Watch for buying cues, asking questions as "how much it cost, how it works, what they need to do to qualify, how much would they save?" Be aware of the situation and tie them down to an appointment and have them provide you the information you need to generate a design and proposal.

Qualified but Shopping: The shoppers are buyers in power, they know they qualified, they've been presented the information multiple times but haven't made a decision. These types of buyers could become time-wasters, which is something we do not need to entertain. Find out if there's still interested and what would it take for them to take action on this opportunity. See if you can help them make a decision, find out the reason why they haven't said yes, and go from there. Usually, these types of buyers, haven't found someone they trust, someone that is knowledgeable enough, or there is not a need to take immediate action.

Not Qualified but Interested: These buyers love your product, would do it if they could, but do not qualify to acquire your service. Unfortunately you will encounter this more than you would like. It is important to ask your qualifying questions to verify if the person you're interacting with qualifies for your service. If they do not, make the best of your situation and see if they know someone that could potentially qualify or want the service, and move on to the next door.

Not Interested: These buyers will say NO, NO, NO. We do not want to waste our time and energy trying to convince someone of the benefits and values of our service. So recognize that not everyone is going to want what you have and the faster you can identify this buyer, move on to the next door or prospect even faster.



Prospecting

What to observe: Look for optimal homes for solar that have south and west-facing roof planes.

What are the keys to qualifying for solar energy?

- Homeowners or be on the title of the home?
- 650 Credit Score (changes with different financing options)?
- The roof of the home has to be in good condition.?
- They need to receive enough sunlight hours. (No shading or very light shading)

Who doesn't qualify?

- Renters do not qualify!
- Poor or bad credit. (Bankruptcy in last 7 years)
- Home in poor condition, (bad roof)
- Home with heavy shading

What do I need to generate a lead? Ask for the electric bill (Contains Annual Usage)

1. First and Last name (Of the homeowner)
2. Email
3. Phone Number
4. Electric Bill (A clear picture of the bill)



6. LAW OF AVERAGE

One of my favorite quotes. "There's always a spring after the winter."

Feeling down = Check your Attitude

Feeling Lazy = Check your Work Ethic

Not getting Results = Check your Approach

Being aware of what area you need to improve within yourself as a sales professional will make your job easier when making adjustments. Self-awareness comes from self-reflection. Keep tabs and data on your progress it's very important to measure where you need to get better.

Attitude = Journal you're day, results, mentality to reflect if you had the right attitude that day to generate the results you needed.

Laziness = Track how many doors you knocked, phone calls made, conversations, and opportunities you created in order to see if your work ethic is where it needs to be. At the end of the day you are the business, if the business is not open to work, the business can't make money. Reflect on your goals and ask yourself if that's what you truly desire.

No Results = Ask for help, record yourself presenting to someone, and see if your confidence level is where it needs to be if you're building rapport, are you asking qualifying questions, Are you listening more than speaking?, Are you creating value? If you can't record yourself then ask someone that's getting results in your office to shadow you and ask them to see what necessary adjustments you need to make to get better results. Read more books on sales, become a more effective communicator, use your personality, or maybe even smiling more often can make a huge difference for any sales professional.



Key Factors for presenting

Excitement and enthusiasm is an easy way to generate curiosity

Your energy introduces you before you even have to

Conviction: tightly held belief

Build Curiosity to Reduce Skepticism

Listen to understand, never to formulate your own response.

- This allows you to pay attention to the needed curiosity points in the conversation, it also allows the customer to be heard, which is necessary.

The first 5 seconds are the most crucial so make it count.

The 3 Factors (S.E.E.) that you need to keep in mind when knocking on doors.

- Smile (Lowers the defenses of strangers when talking to them, Make them feel comfortable talking to you)
- Enthusiasm (No one is going to be excited about the opportunity if you the salesperson is not excited about sharing this opportunity with your potential customers)
- Eye Contact (This builds trust, builds confidence between you and your prospect.) "Can you really trust someone that doesn't look you directly in the eye when talking?"

Break Occupation: "Everyone is busy, or no one has time, I'm in a rush." These are smokescreens so you can leave the front door as fast as possible. (Ask a question) to regain control of the conversation.

3 Key Factors to implement into your presentation

K.I.S.S. > K.I.L.L.

K.I.S.S.: Keep it Short and Simple

K.I.L.L.: Keep it long and lengthy

When breaking pre-occupation and you start to deliver your presentation make sure you Kiss the opportunity with your presentation vs. Killing the opportunity with your presentation



Engaging your prospect: "You're Energy introduces you before you even have to."
Communication

1. 55% Body Language (Energy)
2. 38% Tonality (Sound)
3. 7% The words we choose to speak

Proper Body Language on the door:
Head and chin up, (S.E.E. Factors)
Show palms to show honesty and "Nothing to hide"

Stand at an angle, never face to face or parallel shoulders.
Standing on the side of your prospects builds more trust and rapport, and standing at an angle gives the perception that you are less threatening due to taking up less space.

Tonality: Match the tonality of your prospect, if your prospect has a loud tone, raise your tonality to match your prospect. If your prospect is soft-spoken match the volume to build better rapport.

Words Spoken: The words that you choose to use have a tremendous influence if you choose the right words.



INITIATE SOLAR

Building Rapport

F.O.R.D: A HELPFUL TOOL TO HELP YOU BETTER BUILD RAPPORT

- **Family: “Wow the kids are getting big, what grade are they in?”
“Congratulations on the new baby! It must be a very exciting time for you right now”**
- **Occupation: “It must be really hard being a doctor, I wouldn't be able to deal with all the responsibilities.” (get creative)**
- **Recreation “I see you like the NY Yankees, are they your favorite team?”**
- **Dreams: “What’s your ultimate vacation spot?”**

How can you use FORD to get your prospect better? Create your own questions.

- **F**

- **O**

- **R**

- **D**



INITIATE SOLAR

Building Rapport

Natural Flow of conversation:

BUSINESS, PERSONAL, BUSINESS, PERSONAL.

Some examples of questions to ask the homeowner for needs analysis
These questions were designed to get an insight and understanding of my prospect's needs.

- "How many people live in the house?"
- "Do you use your Air conditioner often?"
- "Does your house use electricity, natural gas, or oil to heat or cool your home?"
- "When was the last time that you had your roof repaired?"
- "Have you looked into going solar in the past?"

Come up with your own questions to better understand your prospect,



Five ways to master your Energy at the door:

1. Speed walk to stay in the zone
2. Do not spend more than 7-8 min in a conversion, go for the close!
3. Do not take a phone call during work hours with anybody that may reduce your energy levels.
4. Practice tonality and increase your energy level until you get uncomfortable
5. Role-play before field time daily.

Transfer of Enthusiasm

Conviction: A firmly held belief

Have enough belief, trust, and excitement over your product and service that you can use the following phrases in your D2D approach:

Opening Questions:

- Do you consider paying for electricity a luxury or necessity?
- do you understand that with your current utility we have absolutely no control\
- How high does your electric bill get during the summertime? Ouch! That's super high, if solar it doesn't have to be so high or unpredictable.
- Most people don't go solar for two reason's 1. It's too expensive 2. They don't fully understand how it all works. Which one of these is the reason for you?
- Are you familiar with how your current utility company charges you for their service?

Common phrases to use at the door to peak curiosity:

- It was very expensive in the past to go solar, a lot has changed in the last couple of years. Today it's easier and more affordable than it's ever been to go solar.
- "At this point, we don't even know if you would qualify, but if you and your home qualify, then you can receive up to 12 months of electricity on us!"
- The federal government is helping homeowners go solar, which is why if you qualify, we guarantee zero out of pocket to go solar with us.
- The utility's way of using electricity is the old way now. Those utility poles and transmission lines you see outside are inefficient, dirty, and cost a whole lot of money to maintain! We as the customers end up paying for it. Now I'm here to help you understand why all of your neighbors are going solar, and you should be too!
- "My job is easy, I'm here to help you understand that solar is a better way to buy power. Can you agree with me that a fixed rate makes more sense than a variable-rate plan like tier bases consumption or time of use?"



More Common phrases to use on the doors:

- "When you go solar, don't forget you are also helping our planet transition to clean energy! You are helping our future generations, while also helping your wallet. Let's set up an appointment to see if you qualify. Does today work at 6 pm?"
- "I need you to understand that I am not asking you for a decision today. All I'm asking is that you allow me to show you why solar is a better way."
- "The worst that'll happen is you will learn something new... The best that could happen is you will qualify for an amazing new program that you didn't even know existed."
-

Common Objections at the door

Not Interested

- Of course, you're not interested, how could you be? You don't know what this is about yet. I'm here to help you understand that there is a better way to buy power.
- "Hey, I'm not here to sell you anything, what I am here to do is share this letter with you that our utility company sent out. A little information never hurt anyone right? Did you receive this?" (Show them an article of their utility company increasing rates)

I don't have time

- I understand...Let me ask you this if you were to give me 30 minutes and I saved you 30-60% or more on your electricity bill, would you call that a good deal?
- Weave into the letter, and what you're educating consumers on
- The two reasons why people aren't going solar today are simply because they don't understand it, or they think it's too expensive. Which one is it for you?

I've heard a lot of bad things/horror stories

- I understand, there are explanations to everything, what sort of things have you heard?
- Targe the problems and do not sidetrack or create new ones
- Leverage management if needed
- Use phrases like "my goal is to educate you"
- "my goal is simply to help homeowners understand that solar today is a better way to buy power"
- "We are an ethical company, which is why we have an educational approach to helping homeowners to go solar. The worst that would happen..."

I already have an appointment with another company

- Awesome, glad to hear you're looking into solar! Would you agree that it would be smart to get a second opinion? Pause...
- We happen to have the best ownership products in the industry, with the lowest interest rates. When can we sit with you?



Come back another time

- If not today, when?
- I want to help you, (apply the two reasons close...)
- persist in bookings sit down, let the customer know that when people say "come back another time" it's usually because they want to keep putting it off.
- Mr. Customer, waiting is only going to cost you more time, energy, and money. Help me save you all of those things and let do this now."
- Go into the close, "the worst that'll happen"... and give them time slots.

Example # 2 of door approach Scenario

Hey/Hello, My name is _____and I am working in your neighborhood today.

Be able to break preoccupation. "I'll be real quick." Move into your pitch and use KISS (KEEP IT SHORT AND SIMPLE) NOT KILL (Keep it long and lengthy)

I am looking to talk to the homeowner, would that be you?

No: Ok, what's the best time that I can come back and talk to him or her?

(Give Options on when you can go back)

Is he or she more available in the evening weekdays or weekends? (Gather your info and keep it moving to the next door.)

Yes: "Yes I am the homeowner"

Great, Nice to meet you!

Perfect, I work with National Grid Customers and educate them on the different programs that are available to them in order to lower their annual electrical cost if they qualify. To verify if you qualify I would need to take a look at your electric bill and see if your home consumes enough electricity annually.

(Get them involved) By following up with a question.

About how much would you say that you invest monthly towards the cost of electricity for your home? Would you say it's more or less than \$100?

Do your best to build rapport with your prospect, this is key to getting the interactions that you want.



Lead Capture

"There are 3 things that are needed to qualify, a home that has a good roof, and that also receives a good amount of sunlight, the person trying to qualify the house has to be the person on the title of the home, and the homeowner has to have a 650 credit score or higher."

During this time you should be observing your prospects body language, their tone of voice, and try to mirror match

Tony Robbins On Rapport Building

ASK FOR THE ELECTRIC BILL! YOU WON'T GET IT IF YOU DON'T ASK.

" Do you happen to have an electric on hand, maybe the one that you paid last?"

No: If they do not have the bill then ask if they do paperless billing, if they do, they should be able to log into their account and get the latest electric bill and also check their monthly/ annually electric consumption.

Alternative: You can always call the electric company directly, have their number saved on your cell phone, so you can call them and ask to get a pdf version of the electric bill sent to the homeowner's email or to your email, in most cases the utility company would then ask to talk to the homeowner to verify that they are the person on their account and to confirm that they can share that information with you.

Yes: "Yes, I have it right here!" "

"Great! With this, I will verify how much electricity you consume and I can give your more detailed information about how this program will work for your home."

Take a picture of the electricity bill, make sure you get a clear visible picture that has the following information:

- 1.Account name
- 2.Address
- 3.Account Number
- 4.Meter Number
- 5.Annual Consumption Graph
- 6.Make sure it's Not older than 2 months old.



Once you have this information then set up a date to come back and provide them with a presentation, set up an appointment to come back.

Always give them options:

"Can I come back during the week or does the weekend work better for you?"

"Would it be best early in the afternoon or later in the evening?"

Make a google calendar appointment and send them an invitation or if you're using your apple calendar make sure you send them an email invitation.

Make sure you collect a good email address and a working phone number that you can use to keep in touch with your prospect. What are the best hours that I can contact you?

After you have solidified your appointment, Set the proper expectations.

Example: "Ok _____ Thank you for providing me with this information that we need, when I come back, I should have more information and details on how this program will benefit you. I want to remind you that not everyone qualifies for this program so I hope that we can help service your home."

Tie your customers down. Make sure you create the following within your conversation with your prospect by utilizing the **F.U.G.I** factors

- Fear of loss:
- Urgency:
- Greed:
- Indifference:



Example #3

Hi, my name is _____. How are you doing?

(Pause)

Great, thanks for asking. I'm from Initiate Solar and you being a _____ (Utility Company) customer, I am educating their customers on how they can potentially use solar energy to power their home.

(Provide them marketing material to look at) D2D slicks

Essentially your utility company is allowing homeowners to produce their own power through the use of solar panels. This is possible through their new net metering program available to homeowners that qualify.

Are you aware of how you are currently being charged for electricity?

Selling Pain: Creating curiosity

"Currently all homeowners are being charged on what is called a tiered rate system. Does this look familiar to you? (Pause)

(Show them a copy of an electric bill)

In short, this means that the more energy you use throughout the month, the more expensive each unit per kWh will become.

"Do you consider your home to be a low or high-energy consumer?"

Low: "That's wonderful, this means that you've avoided paying the tiered 3 rates for electricity 9 out of 12 months of the year.

Unfortunately, over time these rates increase due to inflation, the demand for energy, and the cost it takes to maintain the grid.

This is how utility rates increase even though your lifestyle, behavior, and consumption stay the same.



Selling Pain: Engaging in curiosity and applying pressure

1. Engage in curiosity

- **"What's even going on? Are you even aware?"**
- **"What don't you know? Let me explain/elaborate."**

•

1. Applying pressure

- **"How does this affect you? Did you even know? Do you want to know?"**
- **"How may this affect you in the future? Were you aware? Are you prepared?"**
- **"How attractive are variable rates? Will they increase? Are there alternatives?"**

Value proposition: Chose one to help set up close

1. "As a result of the state and federal government initiative to generate more renewable energy, if your home/family qualifies, we can remove the tiered rate and the time of use system and offer you ONE low flat rate for all the energy your family needs."
2. "When you qualify, we will offer you a whole Solar Panel system for free (complimentary). We will give you all the panels needed. Install them and provide a bumper-to-bumper warranty- all with no upfront cost and zero down payment."

Closing

1. "The only way I can help right now is to set up a quick 30-40 minute consultation. Our energy consultant will review your utility bill with you and your family so you can better understand how the utility company is currently charging you."
2. "We aim to provide you a side-by-side comparison of your current bill with our solar solution so that you can become a more informed consumer."
3. "This way, you can decide what is the best way to buy power for your home instead of letting monopoly-like the utility company tell you what's best for you."



Rebuttals: Addressing, acknowledging, and understanding perspectives

Reasons for objections: Concerns, Misinformed, bad experience, and confusion.

- Address any concerns, question what went wrong, LISTEN, and Identify the problem.
- Acknowledge their concerns, show that you care, LISTEN and acknowledge the problem
- Build rapport through listening and clarify any concerns. Providing clarity will produce curiosity because we have addressed the problem. Acknowledge it, and by providing more clarity to the situation we can begin to build curiosity with the prospect.
- Understanding is the common ground, where the right information combined with an educational approach leads to the client feeling more informed. By challenging skepticism, we surpass clarity and enter the domain of creating an understanding.
- Propose alternatives solutions that address and acknowledge anything the prospect might have misunderstood or have been misinformed on, "I understand, what we're doing is something different than what was presented to you before."
- Feel/Felt/Found: I understand how you feel, other customers have felt the same way, but when they found out that they didn't need to be rich to afford solar, they felt more comfortable about at least listening to the opportunity."

Natural Flow of conversation:

Practice mirroring and matching your prospects, (Tone of voice, Body Language) This helps perceive that you know and/or understand your prospect. We tend to buy from people who are like us.

Fight for the kitchen table! That's where most household decisions are made. Make sure you're presenting to the decision-makers.

KEEP IT BUSINESS, PERSONAL, BUSINESS, PERSONAL. Etc

- A true professional can keep a perfect balance between both building rapport and getting business done throughout the presentation. Remember we only have a few minutes with the customer.

*If you're doing a consultation at the home, take the time out to walk around the home (Ask for permission) Try to take a look at the roof to spot any visible or possible damage to the roof. Maybe you can tell what kind of material the roof is made of.



Example Scenario 4

"Hello, my name is _____. (Show Badge)

I'm here today to follow up with you regarding the net metering program that your utility company offers.

Did you own the home when they replaced your old meter with the new electric smart meter? Did you receive any of the information they sent out in the mail about it and why they did it?

No: "Of course not, most people take those letters and throw them away."

"Yeah, me either. Until I started working here."

That's precisely why I'm here today. Those smart meters were built for two things. They count how much energy you use in your home, and they measure how much energy you put back into the utility grid.

They switched those out on everyone's home because it's part of the state's effort to lower the state's carbon footprint. A Federal Mandate has been passed down to our utility companies to produce at least 30% of their energy through renewable resources.

So you've noticed a lot of your neighbors getting solar panels on their roof, that's not because they won the lottery. It's actually because the government is trying to incentivize people to make the switch, so solar programs have gotten much better. Most people can save between 30-60 % on their current utility bill by making the switch to solar with 0 out-of-pocket costs. My job is to educate homeowners on how to benefit from this program and show you your potential savings if you and your home qualify.

There's a graph on your electric bill that looks like this... This would tell me pretty quickly if you would be a good fit for these programs. You get a hard copy through your mail correct?

Could you go ahead and grab that for me? I can send this graph to my team so that I can bring you back a savings report...

Has anyone come by and explain some of the new solar programs to you?

Capture lead information, ask more qualifying questions and set agenda for appointment.



INITIATE SOLAR

Requesting Design

Look to collect as much information as possible to get the best design tailored to the customer's needs. Notes that you want to include when you requesting a solar design.

Notes to consider:

- Where the homeowner initially wants the panels
- If the homeowner needs more power than what they have been consuming for the last 12 months.
- If the homeowner is looking to cut down trees to go solar.
- Look at roof condition to see if a roof replacement may be necessary
- If the home is a townhouse, highlight which area of the house belongs to the homeowner.
- If a home has more than one meter, which meter will be the one to go solar.

Types of Solar Designs:

- Based on the last 12 months usage
- Based on available roof space
- Maximum production available

New Homeowners with no consumption:

If you have a customer that just bought a house and doesn't have a history of consumption on the home you can request a design based on available roof space. Contact support@initiatesolar.com to get access to our **LOAD CALCULATOR** to get an estimate of how much electricity their home can consume based on the number of appliances, lights, ac units to determine annual consumption.

Home with no google satellite image:

If your home does not appear on google maps or we can find satellite imaging, due to a newly constructed home. Ask for dimensions of the home and we will design a system based on square footage if the homeowner can provide a blueprint of roof dimensions have them email or take pictures for us to create a solar design for the home.



Pricing proposal

Do right by your customer and your customer will do right by you.

How do I price my proposal for the customer?

Give your customer a price that they will be happy to share with others. Although you have the ability to make a great commission on every project sometimes it's best to make some money, then no money at all. Every customer that you help switch to solar might help you acquire another 10 customers that want to switch solar as well. So treat each and every opportunity with great excitement and enthusiasm.

Things to consider when building out your proposal:

- Does the home need a roof replacement?
- Does the homeowner need to cut down or trim trees for solar
- Does the main panel need an upgrade or need to be relocated?
- Is there enough production or do you need higher efficiency panels?
- Does the homeowner want a ground mount system rather than traditional rooftop solar?
- Are we promising the homeowner an installation incentive?
- Are they a referral from a previous customer?
- Extended warranties



Solar Appointment Presentation

Step One: Introduction

Setting Agenda by Setting proper expectations for consultation.

Step Two: Set Agenda

Give Estimated time for consultation, Make sure you sit with all decision-makers)

Step Three: Needs analysis

Transition into Needs Analysis Review, Qualifying questions for better insight on best option for prospect

Step Four: Bill Break Down

show their \$/kWh / Discuss Present Charges/ Future Utility Increases

Step Five: Company overview

Solar Installer + Initiate Solar + You

Step Seven: How would solar work for them?

Net Metering / Interconnection
Show Solar Design, Solar option, and pricing.

Step Six: Discuss Options

(Solar Ownership, Lease, PPA) What works best for them?

Step Eight: Handle Concerns/Objections

Answer all questions (Parking Lot) and customers may have about the service. Verify Credit validation.

Step Nine: Close

Home Installation agreement, Loan Documents, Interconnection Documents, + additional documents that may be needed.

Step Ten: Button Up

Submit closing documents, and ask for referrals. Explain Referral bonuses.



In-Home Presentation

Opening Statement:

" I want to thank you _____ for your time. I am really excited to be here with you today, my goal is to give you enough information to make a well-informed decision when it comes to going Solar with me today. I want you to understand that this is your consultation, and I want to be able to answer any concerns or questions you may have. Please take this piece of paper to write down any questions or anything you may need more explanation or clarification on. (Hand them a piece of paper or make sure they have something to write on to take notes)

During the course of my presentation, I am confident that I'll cover all aspects of this opportunity. But feel free to interrupt or interject at any time so I can write it down for me and address it at the end of the consultation if it's something I did not cover in my initial presentation.

The consultation should only take about 30-40 minutes depending on how many questions you may have. First I am going to start by asking you basic qualifying questions while we do a walk around of your property , then we will break down your electric bill. We will talk about why you're electricity is priced the way it is. I will give you a brief overview of myself and the company I choose to work for. Then we will discuss your options and I can give you my opinion on what may be best for you. I will show your customized solar design, production report, and explain how the solar system will work simultaneously with your utility provider to power your home. We review your warranties, maintenance, and possible repair cost. And finally, we will review our notes to see if I left any questions or concerns unanswered before moving forward. Does that sound fair?

With that being said, If everything makes sense and we understand how everything works, we will verify if you qualify for this service through a soft-credit verification. If you qualify and agree to move forward we will get all documents needed to get you approved for the project and get you installed to start producing your own power. How does that sound?

Key Factors about in-home consultant:

- Fight for the kitchen table, do your best to present at the kitchen table where you will have ample room to do your presentation, keep yourself organized, and provide your homeowner visual aids to help your presentation.
- Use your S.E.E. Factors
- Mirror-match your prospect



Starting your Presentation

Have your customer ready for the presentation with pen and paper. This is important because you want them to be involved, being able to write down any notes or questions they may have for you without interrupting your presentation. It is most likely that their question will be answered at some time or point in the presentation. So politely ask them to write it down so that you can answer the question at the end of the presentation if it wasn't answered during the presentation. You want to call this the parking lot.

The Parking lot is where all the questions go, so they can be answered at the end of the presentation. Never leave a question unanswered, if you don't know the answer, don't guess, be honest and say you don't know what you will get a manager to answer for you, at that point contact your manager to help you out with the question.

NEEDS ANALYSIS

During the needs analysis, the point is to gather intel or information about our prospects so we can effectively provide them with the perfect solution to their problem. At the same time, it is a perfect way to build rapport, build trust between you and your prospect. In order for the sale to be successfully made is by building trust between you and the prospect. Let them get to know you, let your personality shine, and smile often.

How do we do this? We do this by asking qualifying questions. Choose 4-5 for your consultation

"Have you looked into go solar before?"

"Do you know the different options you have?"

"How do you like living here?"

"Are you planning on moving in the next few years?"

"Any plans for remodeling?"

"How long have you lived in the home?"

"Will the # of people change?"

"When do you typically use the majority of your power?"

"Have you ever thought about going solar in the past?"

"Do you have any money set aside for solar?"

"How old is your roof?"

"Are you planning on making any additions to the house that may increase your electricity consumption, like a pool, hot tub, or an electric vehicle?"

Always have the prospect elaborate on these questions.



INITIATE SOLAR

Walk around

Objective: Get homeowners involved and help them visualize and assume the agreement.

1. Ask to see the electrical panel/breaker. Explain amperage. Describe MPU availability with solar.
2. Have homeowner visualize mounting planes. Locate southern and west-facing mounting planes. Explain Azimuth.
3. Referral Weave. Redirect attention from being hesitant to potential gains and benefits.

Things to look for:

- Roof condition
- Possible shading issues
- Take a look at their meter, see if it's an old meter or if it's been updated. Help the prospect envision their solar system and installation process, use words of ownership. ("Your system will be placed here." "You're new meter will be placed here.")
- Some houses have their electrical panel outside next to their meter if you can see how many watts the panel has 50W, 100W, 150W, and 200W+ are your common home panel sizes.
- Take pictures if possible. (We want to gather as much information as possible for your records and also for the project coordinators and site audit team.)
- Solar Systems need at least 100W-200W electrical panels, anything less would have to upgrade the Main Panel

Assume Agreement: As you go through the consultation it's important to use certain phrases and rhetoric to not just guide them through the process, but subconsciously develop their personal commitment. It's not if, but when. Example: "That's why when you go solar with me today...." "When the surveyors and install team comes..."

Referral Weaving: Assuming past the agreement. Referral weaving is a process of incorporating incentives into the sales process. This redirects the homeowners' attention from potential doubts to personal gains-shifting their focus from "why not" to "what if". Referrals benefit everybody, and that's why it is essential to try to weave it into your sales pitch whenever you can!

Transition Statement:

"Before we go inside, were there any questions or concerns that you had when it comes to where and why we want to place the panels where we visualized them? Do you understand the MPU upgrade and how the azimuth worked? Excellent, would you mind if we head back inside so we can make a side-by-side comparison and show you why solar makes so much sense compared to traditional utility companies and the service they provide.



INITIATE SOLAR

Bill Break Down

Objective: Break down the power bill. Be professional and Sell the Pain.

Study the bill

Some Utility companies have **Tier Rates** (Tier 1, Tier 2, Tier 3) which means that those customers get charged more per kWh depending on what level of consumption the house is in. The higher the consumption, the higher the price per kWh.

Some utility companies have a **Time of Use** system. This means the customer's price per kWh will vary depending on the Time of Use that they consume their electricity. These systems have an Off/On-Peak. Meaning they will get charged higher electric rates per kWh when it's On-Peak hours vs. Lower electrical rates during Off-Peak hours.

Show them exactly how much they pay towards the 4 charges in the utility bill. Have them write it down (super powerful). From the Graph write the usage for every month. If the bill does not have a consumption graph or the graph is that legible, call the utility company to receive actual monthly consumption for the home.

Then get the total of the bill and divide it by the number of kWh they were charged for. We do this to show the customer exactly how much they are currently paying per kWh (kilowatt-hour) with their Utility Company.

Give a brief explanation; example;

"Your Local utility has a power plant where they generate electricity, some Utility companies generate electricity by the use of Nuclear power or by burning fossil fuels like natural gas or oil. That generated electricity then gets transported through the power cables to local distribution centers where they go through your local power cables until it reaches your home."



Bill Break Down

Use Visual Aids: The help of visual aids during this area of the presentation is crucial to use the visual aids to your advantage. You can use our Presentation visual aids, and videos to help make the explanation easier.

Key Factors

- **Sell the Pain:** Show how we as consumers are at the mercy of the utility companies and we have little say in the practices.
- **Control/Pace of conversation:** You're the expert, guide them through the process. The best way to control conversation is by asking engaging questions.
- **Understand Tonality and Delivery:** We all say the same things, the difference is the way and how we deliver our message that makes the biggest difference.
- **Be informative and Engaging:** Sales is a spectators sport, so get your prospect involved, by having them read things from their utility bill like "How many KWH did we consume for the month of June 2020?"
- **Create Polarities:** Emphasize the difference when it comes to Utility Vs Solar.
- **Call to action:** Be bold, assume the Agreement, Display conviction.
- **Benefits of Solar:** Protection, Control, predictability.
- **Analogies:** relatable statements are easily understood and attention-grabbing.



Usage Breakdown

Objective: Show them exactly how much they pay towards the 4 charges in the utility bill. Have them write it down (super powerful).

Then get the total cost of the bill and divide it by the number of kWh they were charged for. We do this to show the customer exactly how much they are currently paying per kWh (kilowatt-hour) with their Utility Company.

Example:

Total Cost \$600 for the month/ Electric Consumption 3200 Kwh = Average cost per kWh = \$0.1875 per Kwh

Have the prospect write this down for themselves. It means more to the prospect when they write it down and do the math themselves.

This is where the sale is made, you need to effectively build the pain. What's our prospect's pain? Overpaying for electricity that they purchase through their local utility. (Your prospect is sick, and they called us so we can send you to give them the solution to relieve their pain. That's the purpose of our meeting).

Build Pain with Questions, Let them answer and be quiet and listen to them.

Have you ever taken a look at your electric bill and understand what they're charging you for? Don't worry most homeowners don't know, all the services that the utility charges you for. **"Let's look at your utility bill and figure out exactly what and where your money is going towards."**

1. Generation Cost: The cost of the production of your electricity.
2. Delivery Charge: The cost associated with the delivery of your electricity.
3. Basic Service Charge: The cost to service your home. (Covers Maintenance and upgrades of the electric grid.)
4. Taxes, and special programs to help save the environment (Federal Mandate)

- Ask questions to gauge their knowledge about their local electricity provider
- Discover Pain Points
- Teach how they are charged



Usage Breakdown

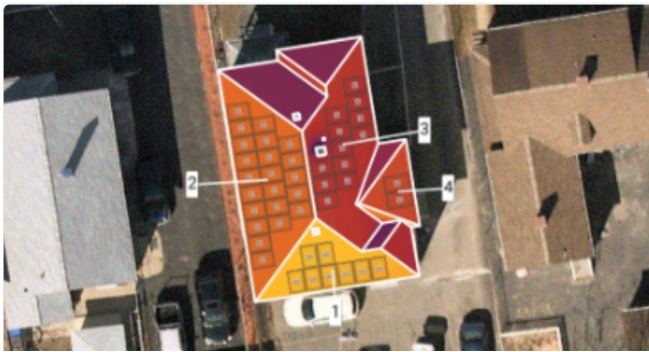
Month	kWh Consumption		Annual Cost	
			Utility Cost	Solar Cost
January		Year 1		
February		Year 2		
March		Year 3		
April		Year 4		
May		Year 5		
June		Year 6		
July		Year 7		
August		Year 8		
September		Year 9		
October		Year 10		
November		Year 11		
December		Year 12		
 INITIATESOLAR		Year 13		
		Year 14		
		Year 15		
		Year 16		
		Year 17		
		Year 18		
		Year 19		
		Year 20		



Solar Breakdown

Transition:

"As you can see, this is how much you've been consuming for the last 12 months, this is how much you spend annually for your electricity, and this is how it's estimated to look in the future. Now I am going to show you, your customized solar design for your home. This designed is tailored specifically for your home's needs. The first step would be to analyze the placement of the panels and see how much electricity we will be able to produce for your home on an annual basis."



Walk your prospect through the reasoning of the design. Explain to them what azimuth means and why it's important. Make adjustments if needed, sometimes homeowners request that they don't want any panels on the front-facing side of the house.

How does Solar work? How will it affect my bill?

Review with your customer how solar panels produce their energy.
Explain to them the placement of the panel for their home.
Explain to them how the interconnection of the solar with their utility company works.
Explain to them how net metering works with their utility.

Things to review with your customer about their solar system.

Equipment: Type of Modules, Type of Inverter, Mounting System

Production: How much electricity is the system going to produce annually



Company Overview

Why do business with us or Why choose me?

Developing a relationship with your customer is very important. Today there are more and more new solar companies coming out every day. What makes you different from the pack? The price difference between companies is very minimal, how can you get your customer to choose you over the competition?

Have a story to tell:

The story can be about anything, the point is that the story shows the authenticity, honesty, and integrity of your character. Make sure that the story is professional enough to share. Our goal here is to build up a bit more rapport if it's needed. Some homeowners just want the meat and potatoes and have no care about you or your company, if so there may be a lack of rapport with the homeowner. Do not be just another solar guy. Be the last solar guy that they'll have to meet and speak with. Make your personality shine and remember for S.E.E. factors.

Who are you?

Why are you doing this?

Why did you choose to work with Initiate Solar?

Show results of your happy customers.

Tell them about our referral bonus

If you are able to get them to trust you and you're able to help them with your knowledge about solar they are more willing to say yes to you over the competition.

Before they say **Yes**, they will say **NO**.



Discuss Option

What is your customer's option when it comes to going solar?

PPA: Power Purchase Agreement

- No Financing
- No Lien Against property, Lien on equipment if not payments made.
- System Monitoring
- Transferable to the new homeowner
- Agreeing to purchase power, not the system
- You do not own the system
- Fixed pricing
- Predictable monthly payments
- No financial responsibility to the maintenance and repairs to the system
- Fully warranted
- Little liability
- Monthly payments are determined by the amount of estimated annual production of the solar system

With Leases or PPA's, there are little or no upfront costs. The solar provider is responsible for all monitoring, maintenance, and repairs for the length of the agreement. Minimum energy production is often guaranteed. Selling the home in the future may be more complicated than with a purchased system. Options typically are: the new owner must agree to take on the agreement, you continue making payments, or you buy out the agreement, which could be thousands of dollars. Federal and state incentives are applied to the pricing of your PPA or Lease agreement so the homeowner doesn't have to qualify or apply for federal/state tax credits.

Best Fit for PPA/Lease:

- Good Credit but Low-Income families
- Veterans
- Elderly on a budget
- Homeowners that do not pay taxes
- A homeowner that doesn't want to take on more debt.
- Looking to save money short term vs long term



Discuss Option

What is your customer's option when it comes to going solar?

Ownership/Financing & Cash Purchase

- No money down (Cash Purchase: Downpayment varies by EPC provider)
- No out of pocket cost
- No lien against the property
- Low-Interest Rates
- System Monitoring
- Transferrable Loan agreement

With Cash purchase or Loan, typically the homeowner sees a greater return on investment. If you use a loan, little or no upfront costs. May increase the value of the home. They can directly receive tax credits and deductions. Review with your customer state incentives if applicable to your customer. Remind the customer that you are not a tax professional and that you recommend that they talk to their Consult tax professional to see if they qualify for tax credits. They are typically responsible for repairs and maintenance. Some EPC providers include maintenance and repairs. Make sure that you research your EPC's warranties. Some solar loans place a lien on your property. In those cases, if you do not make your payments, this could result in foreclosure or make it more difficult to sell your home or refinance your mortgage. Other loans just put a mechanic's lien on the solar system, not the home. (The loans we provide homeowners just put a mechanic's lien on the solar equipment, not the home. If a homeowner fails to make the financed monthly payments, could result in repossession of the solar system.)

Best Fit for Ownership:

- A homeowner with a healthy DTI ratio (Debt to Income)
- Homeowners with taxable income
- Looking for long-term savings.
- Not looking to sell their home in the near future.
- Looking to invest in their home
- Looking to eliminate electric bill or reduce overall annual cost for electricity



Handle Common Objections or Concerns

Bypassing and shelving concerns

If you get hit with an objection or concern early in the presentation, don't try to handle it at that moment. Shelf it and bypass it like this.

"_____, I understand, with your permission I will like to make a note of that concern. But, I'd also like, because I'm here and tonight will be an educational experience, I hope I can continue and let's talk about the money later. Would that be ok?"

The reasons why your customer may cut you off and ask questions could be to derail you from your presentation and to gain control of the conversation. By you bypassing and shelving the concern we are staying on track of our presentation and minimizes distractions or starting conversations that have nothing to do with what you're looking to explain at the moment.

By writing the concern down on our notepad, we are acknowledging the concern of our customer and we will review our notepad with all the concerns and questions that we didn't cover in our presentation at the end of the presentation.

Identifying Positive Buying Cues

Verbal Cues

- Asking more questions
- Asking you to repeat something
- Asking you technical questions, questions he wouldn't need the answers unless he owned the product
- Noises

Visual Cues

- Leaning Forward
- Warming up to you, smiling
- Intently looking at the visuals
- Showing some affection with another (Couples)



Concerns & Objections

Concerns

- Roof in bad condition
- What if I sell my home?
- I don't think I can afford it
- Bad experience
- Warranties/Maintenance

Objections

- Not interested
- I don't have time
- I've heard a lot of bad things
- I already have an appointment with another company
- Come back another time

S.P.R

When responding to either a concern or Objection use the acronym **S.P.R**

Stimulus: A comment, Statement, area of concern, or answer to your question that your prospect might give you.

Pause: Listen intently, do not interrupt, smile to lower defense, nod your head to physically acknowledge what you are listening to what they are saying as they speak. Create some eye contact to build trust.

Response: Acknowledge their comment or statement and respond accordingly.

List different types of concerns and objections and come up with your own way to S.P.R.



Handle Common Objections or Concerns

Why do business with us or Why choose me?

I'm concerned about the savings.

"I understand how you feel, can we agree that we as consumers of ___Utility___ have no control over how they charge us for their service? Can we also agree that the price of having their service has been increasing little by little every year for the last 20 years? This is the reason why homeowners are choosing to produce their own power because of the long term benefits and savings compared to consuming electricity from ___Utility___. The predictability over your billing and control of owning your own power. "

I'm concerned about paying more to Utility at the end of the year.

"I understand, _____. That's called a true-up bill, and today I'm going to show you exactly how I will prevent that from happening to you. It's very simple. The reason why maybe someone you know, or you've heard of having an end-of-year bill, is because sometimes people do not get enough panels installed initially, and they are consuming more energy than what the system can produce for them annually. That's why I am here to assess your energy needs, and I asked you about future additions to the home or if you planning on buying an Electric Vehicle. We have also confirmed with your Utility Company your historical electric consumption to get the more precise estimation possible. Our objective is to provide you with 100%+ of what you need to prevent that from happening."

I get less than 100%+ of the energy that I need.

"I understand, _____. Although we can not accomplish your goal of 100% offset, you can still lock in your rate for the amount that you can offset. That's electricity that you will never have to consume and purchase at a higher rate as you would with your Utility Company because your producing your power with solar and solar will still provide you with savings. You can always try to lower your overconsumption by installing a smart thermostat, or maybe doing upgrades to the home like a central air system if you're using individual AC units, insulating the house if it has no insulation, replacing old doors and windows, replacing traditional light bulbs with energy-saving LED lights.

"With solar, you'll be able to monitor your daily electrical production, and at the end of the month you'll get a review of the month, showing you, you're electric production and your consumption for the month. The electricity you need from the grid will be purchased at the utility rate that you're currently purchasing at the moment. The electricity that your solar produces is always going to be more economical as compared to the electricity you need to consume from your utility company."



Handle Common Objections or Concerns

Why do business with us or Why choose me?

I'm concerned about the financing.

All of our finance partners are insurance and credited with the ABB. They provide financing for homeowners looking to go solar. They also provide financing for other home improvement projects. All you need to qualify with them is a credit score of 650 or better and you'll be able to go solar with no money down. They do not put a lien on your home but they file a UCC-1 form, mechanic's lien on the solar equipment if you were to file for bankruptcy. It simply lets the bank know that the system is ours until it's paid off. But it does not go against your home or prevents you from refinancing, selling, etc.

What if the Solar system doesn't work?

"You will have access to view the production of your solar system, if you notice your system is underperforming contact us at customercare@initiatesolar.com. We will get in contact with your installer and they will contact you to set up a date and time that they can come and inspect the system. If a component like the solar panels or inverter fails to operate, they are covered by the manufacturers' warranty for 25 years. You have a guaranteed production of 85% by the end of 25 years.

Does my solar work even though it's not sunny?

"You're solar panels create an electrical charge by harnessing photovoltaic light rays, which still penetrates clouds even on the cloudiest of days. So your panels will still produce electricity, just not with the same efficiency as compared to a clear sunny day."

"So if I have solar, that means I'll no longer get an electric bill?"

"No, even though you have a solar system and the solar is producing the energy you need. You will still receive your electric bill every month. Due to the interconnection with the grid, the Utility company will always stay connected to your home to supplement you with power when you need it. Your Net meter will first use the credits of overproduction first, once all energy credits have been used, then you will get charged for any excess energy that you may need outside the production capacity of the solar system."



Handle Common Objections or Concerns

Why do business with us or Why choose me?

What if I want to sell my house?

"I'm glad you asked me that question, if you decide to sell your home you first have to contact your solar finance company and tell them that you are looking to put your house on the market. Once that is done, you can transfer the loan agreement to the new homeowner or you can add the cost of the solar on top of the sale of the house so you can get rid of the loan at the same time that you sell the house."

I don't like the way the panels look?

"Yea you're right, the panels might not be the most aesthetically pleasing sight all the time, but we can agree that the benefits that they provide you outweigh the way the panels look. The Prius doesn't scream sexy, but it's one of the most popular cars today because of all the savings they provide as compared to a traditional car."

Can I pay off the loan ahead of time?

"Absolutely, there are no pre-penalties against paying off the system ahead of time. Once you pay off the solar loan, you'll really see the big difference between owning your power and consuming your power from the electrical grid."

"What if better panels and technology comes up?"

"Solar technology hasn't changed much in the last 50 years, the efficiency in panel technology doesn't grow much the highest efficiency rating you could find 10 years ago was 15%, and today, it's about 21% at the highest point. The biggest change has been that today they are sleeker, thinner, black on black, and look amazing."

"I don't think the system will produce what you say it will."

"I understand the way we were able to calculate the production of your system is by using software that estimates the amount of sunlight your roof receives annually by taking to account your azimuth of where the solar panels will be placed. Knowing the number of sun-hours and the type of panels we will use to produce we can accurately calculate your annual production. We also set a site-audit date to complete a shade study to verify our calculations. And our Tier-1 Panels also come with an 85% production guarantee. "



Handle Common Objections or Concerns

Why do business with us or Why choose me?

What if my roof starts to leak, once I have the solar panels installed?

"We provide a 10-Year roof penetration warranty. If you have a leak due to the installation of our system, contact us, and we will make sure someone comes out here and seals any leaks due to the installation of the system"

What happens if I have a leak after the first 10 years?

"If you don't have a leak in the first 3 years of you having the system installed the odds of you having a leak in the future is very very slim. All roof penetrations are sealed tight so you won't have any leaks for the next 10+ years but if you do, just contact us to get someone to service your roof."

How do I claim my ITC Credits?

"All you have to do is print out a copy of your installation agreement, talk to your tax advisor and show them your purchase of the solar system. Your tax advisor should be knowledgeable about how to claim your Investment Tax Credits. Contact customercare@initiatesolar.com for more help "

"Cost More Than Competitors-

"You know, we actually hear that from time to time. We pride ourselves in the flexibility of working with our homeowners to provide them with a fair price that works for both the company and the homeowner. About how much more is our project compared to the competition?"

"I can get it for cheaper."

"That may be very true_____, and in today's economy, we definitely want to get the most out of our hard-earned money. The truth that I have learned is that the cheapest is most likely what we really do not want. Most homeowners look at 3 things when deciding on what company to go solar with 1. Finest quality; 2. Best service; or 3. Lowest Price. I have yet to find a company that can provide the finest quality, best service, and lowest price, I'm curious _____ which one of these are you willing to sacrifice for your long-term happiness with your investment today? "



Handle Common Objections or Concerns

I need to think about it

"I understand _____ you wouldn't be taking the time to think it over unless you were really interested in getting solar would you? I mean, I'm sure you're not just telling me that to get rid of me, right? So, may assume that you will take this opportunity into heave consideration? Just to clarify which part about this opportunity do you need to think about? Is it the quality of service that I'll provide? Is it something that I've failed to cover? Seriously, level with me, is it the money?"

Most of the thing when people say they need to sleep on it, think about it, it's usually a stall tactic keeping them from saying yes. Our objective is to find the true motivation of the stall and the true objection.

Need to Research You/Product-

"Yes, you do, that's exactly why I am here. What is it that you need to know about the product or company that you need to know so you can make a more informed decision?"

No Need-

"Ok, I agree with you, would you say that at one point or another you purchased something that you didn't want or need immediately but eventually it came in handy in the future? This would be a situation where you're making a decision not based on your current situation but a decision that will protect you from future utility increases, can we agree that you have no control over the way that your local utility company raises their cost yearly?"

Not Interested

"I understand that there are 3 reasons why most homeowners lose interest in this opportunity,

- 1) They don't understand how this works
- 2) They can not afford what I am offering or
- 3) they simply don't like me.

Would you say that one of these 3 scenarios applies to you at the moment?"

